Startup Evaluation – Step-by-Step Assessment Forms

Developer Task (StartupReady AI Platform)

Objective

The evaluation process should feel like an **AI mentor conducting a startup health check**, not an examination. Each step collects structured information, provides immediate feedback, and updates the startup's readiness score in real time.

Total Time: 25–40 minutes (with Save & Resume)

Progress Example

Startup Evaluation

Step 3 of 15

 22%

Estimated Time Left: 28 Minutes

Step 1 – Startup Overview

Purpose

Understand the startup at a high level.

Form

Startup Snapshot

- Startup Name (Read Only)
- Industry
- Sector
- Current Stage
- Business Model
- Year Started
- Number of Employees
- Number of Founders
- Headquarters
- Website

Business Summary

- Describe your startup in one sentence
- Elevator Pitch (250 words)
- Vision
- Mission

AI Assistance

- Generate Elevator Pitch
- Improve Business Summary
- Rewrite Professionally

Step 2 – Problem & Solution Validation

Problem

- What problem are you solving?
- Who experiences this problem?
- How frequently does it occur?
- How serious is the problem?

Solution

- Explain your solution
- Why is it different?
- Key innovations
- Is any IP involved?

Customer Validation

- Number of interviews conducted
- Pilot customers
- Customer testimonials
- User feedback

Upload

- Customer survey
- Testimonials
- Research reports

AI Output

- Problem Clarity Score

- Innovation Score
- Validation Score

Step 3 – Market Opportunity

Market Details

- Target Industry
- Customer Segment
- Geography
- TAM
- SAM
- SOM
- Market Growth (%)
- Market Size

Competition

- Top Competitors
- Competitive Advantages
- Entry Barriers

Customer Persona

- Primary Customer
- Buyer Persona
- Decision Maker

AI Analysis

- Market Attractiveness
- Competitive Position
- Growth Potential

Step 4 – Product Readiness

Product Status

- Idea
- Prototype
- MVP

- Beta
- Live Product

Product Features

- Core Features
- Product Roadmap
- Product Differentiation
- User Experience

Usage Metrics

- Registered Users
- Active Users
- Daily Active Users
- Monthly Active Users

Upload

- Demo Video
- Screenshots
- Product Brochure

AI Analysis

- Product Maturity
- User Readiness
- Product Completeness

Step 5 – Technology Assessment

Architecture

- Technology Stack
- Cloud Platform
- APIs
- Database
- Security Framework
- AI Usage
- Blockchain Usage
- DevOps Pipeline

Scalability

- Multi-Tenant
- Auto Scaling
- Disaster Recovery
- High Availability

Security

- Authentication
- Encryption
- Audit Logs
- Compliance

AI Score

- Technology Maturity
- Scalability
- Security Readiness

Step 6 – Business Model

Revenue

- Revenue Model
- Pricing Strategy
- Subscription
- Licensing
- Marketplace
- Transaction Fee

Economics

- CAC
- LTV
- Gross Margin
- Customer Retention
- Churn

Growth Strategy

- Upselling

- Cross-selling
- Expansion Plans

AI Analysis

- Revenue Sustainability
- Business Model Strength
- Unit Economics Score

Step 7 – Team Assessment

Leadership

- Founder Experience
- Industry Expertise
- Technical Skills
- Business Skills

Team

- Technology Team
- Sales Team
- Marketing Team
- Operations
- Advisors

Hiring

- Current Open Positions
- Hiring Plan (12 months)

AI Score

- Leadership Strength
- Team Completeness
- Execution Capability

Step 8 – Financial Readiness

Financial Metrics

- Annual Revenue
- Monthly Revenue

- Burn Rate
- Runway
- Profitability
- EBITDA
- Gross Margin

Financial Planning

- Revenue Forecast (3 Years)
- Expense Forecast
- Cash Flow
- Break-even Timeline

Upload

- Financial Model
- P&L
- Balance Sheet
- Cash Flow

AI Analysis

- Financial Health
- Sustainability
- Investment Readiness

Step 9 – Legal & Compliance

Company

- Incorporated
- Company Type
- GST
- PAN
- CIN

Legal

- Founder Agreement
- Shareholders Agreement
- ESOP Policy

- Privacy Policy
- Terms of Service

IP

- Trademark
- Patent
- Copyright

Compliance

- Startup India
- DPDP Compliance
- ISO Certifications
- SOC 2

AI Score

- Legal Readiness
- Compliance Risk
- Documentation Completeness

Step 10 – Sales & Go-to-Market

Sales

- Sales Channels
- Sales Team
- Sales Cycle
- Conversion Rate

Marketing

- SEO
- Digital Marketing
- Partnerships
- Referral Programs

Customers

- Customer Acquisition Cost
- Retention Rate
- Repeat Customers

AI Output

- GTM Readiness
- Sales Effectiveness
- Growth Strategy Score

Step 11 – Traction & Growth

Business Metrics

- Customers
- Revenue Growth
- MRR
- ARR
- Transactions
- Partnerships
- Awards
- Media Coverage

Growth

- Month-on-Month Growth
- Year-on-Year Growth

AI Score

- Traction Score
- Growth Momentum
- Market Acceptance

Step 12 – ESG & Impact

Sustainability

- Environmental Impact
- Social Impact
- Governance

Diversity

- Women Leadership
- Inclusive Hiring

- Accessibility

SDGs

- Select UN Sustainable Development Goals

AI Output

- ESG Score
- Sustainability Readiness

Step 13 – Investment Readiness

Funding

- Funds Raised
- Current Valuation
- Funding Required
- Use of Funds
- Runway After Funding

Investor Assets

- Pitch Deck
- Data Room
- Cap Table
- Financial Model
- Due Diligence Documents

AI Analysis

- Investment Readiness
- Investor Confidence
- Due Diligence Score

Step 14 – Risk Assessment

Strategic Risks

- Market Risk
- Competition
- Technology Risk
- Regulatory Risk

- Financial Risk
- Operational Risk
- Cybersecurity Risk
- Founder Dependency

Mitigation

- Existing Controls
- Contingency Plans

AI Output

- Overall Risk Rating
- Critical Risks
- Mitigation Recommendations

Step 15 – Final AI Evaluation

AI-Generated Startup Scorecard

Overall Scores (0–100)

Category	Score
Vision & Innovation	92
Market Opportunity	88
Product Readiness	84
Technology	91
Business Model	85
Team	89
Financial Health	74
Legal & Compliance	70
Sales & GTM	80
Traction	76
ESG	65
Investment Readiness	82

Overall Funding Readiness

88%

★★★★☆

Seed / Pre-Series A Ready

AI SWOT Analysis

- Strengths
- Weaknesses
- Opportunities
- Threats

Top 10 Improvement Recommendations

Each recommendation includes:

- Priority (Critical / High / Medium / Low)
- Expected score improvement
- Estimated effort (Hours/Days)
- Suggested owner (Founder, CTO, CFO, Legal, Marketing)
- **"Start with AI"** button to generate templates, policies, or content.

Downloadable Reports

- Executive Startup Health Report
- Funding Readiness Report
- Investor Due Diligence Summary
- Mentor Review Report
- Startup Improvement Roadmap
- AI SWOT Analysis
- Benchmark Comparison Report

Developer UX Requirements

Every evaluation step should include:

- **Progress indicator**
- **Autosave**
- **AI Copilot sidebar**
- **Contextual help ("Why are we asking this?")**
- **Skip & complete later** (where applicable)
- **Upload supporting documents**
- **Inline validation**
- **Live scoring updates**
- **Industry benchmarking**
- **"Improve with AI"** action for text responses

This design transforms the evaluation into an engaging, guided experience that not only assesses the startup but actively helps founders improve their funding readiness before approaching investors